

SEXUALLY EXPLICIT MATERIAL

NURS 280 JUNE 11, 2026



HOW COMMON IS PORN USE?



91.5% of men and 60.2% of women reported having consumed pornography in the past month

Lifetime use: 98.9% of men and 91.9% of women

WHAT IS THE IMPACT OF PORN ON PEOPLE'S SEX LIVES?



62% No impact

25% Positive impact

11% Mixed impact (positive and negative)

2% Only negative impact

WHY DO PEOPLE VIEW PORN?



Sexual entertainment or arousal

- masturbating
- for fun or interest
- getting turned on

Information gathering

- exploring new ideas
- learning about sex or pleasure

SOME PROBLEMS WITH PORN

- Misrepresentation of bodies
- How pleasure is depicted
- Violence
- Exploitation of performers



THINGS YOU DON'T SEE IN MAINSTREAM PORN



@hazel.mead

SOME BENEFITS OF PORN

- Exploration of sexual expression: pleasure, fantasy, identity
- Can support healthy masturbation
- Can facilitate connection between partners, building trust, exploration, add novelty, boost excitement, etc.



“PORN ADDICTION”

- Not recognized by any diagnostic manuals (DSM-5, ICD-11, etc.), or any reputable professional associations
- When studied, people who report problems regulating their porn use do not exhibit the type of brain activity seen in addicts

Prause, N., Steele, V. R., Staley, C., Sabatinelli, D., & Hajcak, G. (2015). Modulation of late positive potentials by sexual images in problem users and controls inconsistent with “porn addiction.” *Biological Psychology*, 109, 192-199.

- While people can certainly consume porn compulsively, most therapists would consider compulsive behaviours to be treatable

Video interview with Dr. Nicole Prause



DOES PORN RUIN RELATIONSHIPS?

A large US/Canadian study found no link between porn use and relationship satisfaction. Recent studies show that porn watching may *increase* sexual desire for one's partner and does not lower our rating of our partner's attractiveness

Vaillancourt-Morel, M. P., Rosen, N. O., Willoughby, B. J., Leonhardt, N. D., & Bergeron, S. (2020). Pornography use and romantic relationships: A dyadic daily diary study. *Journal of Social and Personal Relationships*, 37(10-11), 2802-2821.

Balzarini R. N., Dobson K., Chin K., Campbell L. (2017). Does exposure to erotica reduce attraction and love for romantic partners in men? Independent replications of Kenrick, Gutierrez, and Goldberg (1989) study 2. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology*, 70, 191–197.



DOES PORN BREAK YOUR PENIS?

Dr. Justin Lehmiller reports that rates of erectile difficulties has remained constant, even as porn consumption increases. Recent research shows that men who watch porn are no more likely to experience erectile issues. In fact, porn use was linked to *more* arousal.

Prause, N., & Pfaus, J. (2015). Viewing sexual stimuli associated with greater sexual responsiveness, not erectile dysfunction. *Sexual Medicine*.

Landripet, I., & Štulhofer, A. (2015). Is pornography use associated with sexual difficulties and dysfunctions among younger heterosexual men? *The Journal of Sexual Medicine*.



DOES PORN REWIRE YOUR BRAIN?

No study has ever demonstrated that. Why would porn-watching produce different effects than other pleasurable experiences?



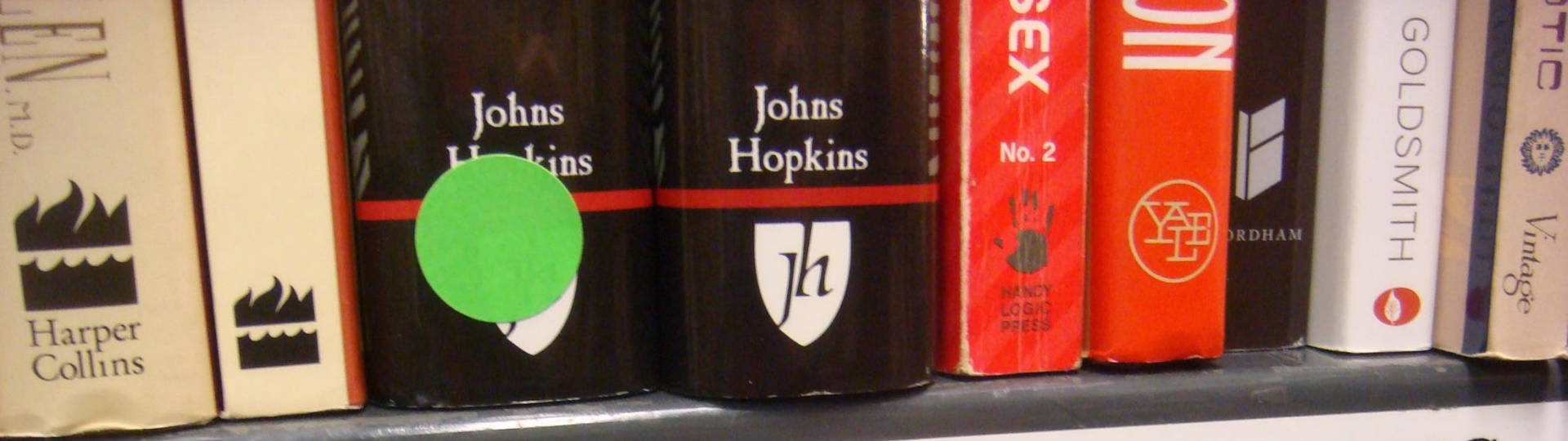
CAN WE ETHICALLY CONSUME PORN?

Clinical psychologist Dr. David Ley offers this list of qualities for ethical porn:

- Made legally
- Respects the rights of performers
- Pays performers for their labour
- Shows both fantasy sex AND real-world sex, so that we can see and explore both
- Is as diverse as the people consuming it—showing all the thirty-one million different flavors of people that are out there
- Celebrates sexuality as a diverse, complex and multi-faceted component of being human, without saying there is a right or wrong way to be sexual
- Is made by people who are trying to make “better porn” and is watched by people who want there to BE “better porn”
- Treats both performers and consumers of porn as free, consenting, thinking and powerful beings

Ley, D. J. (2016). *Ethical porn for dicks: A man's guide to responsible viewing pleasure*. ThreeL Media.





SEXUALITY CONTINUES



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

